



“I came to India literally with no business plan but kept exploring opportunities [that] would make that kind of impact [that Microsoft’s products had on the lives of ordinary people]”

Indians who are actually buying eyewear; and then there is that part of the market that is not even getting an eye test [done]. That’s a large part of the market too. So, even on the market that exists, almost 85-90 per cent is still unorganised, both at the retail level as well as the product level. So the retailer is unorganised as well as the product that they are selling is largely unorganised. You will be surprised to learn that Luxottica [Italian eyewear conglomerate EssilorLuxottica], all put together, forms only a very small portion—even from a product perspective—of the Indian ecosystem.

Q: So, you spoke about this 50-60 per cent growth. Where is it coming from? Is it through your ever-growing collection of stores which is the offline part of it? Or is it mostly online? What would you say is the real thrust area, between offline and online?

A: The two feed into each other. I would say that the lines between channels are diminishing. Gone are the days where you can bucket consumers and say this is an online customer or [this] is an offline customer. If you look at the last four- or five-year trajectory, you would see that consumers overlap between these channels. And that’s actually the strength of Lenskart. We are not a company that pushes people to a particular channel by offering special discounts. I’ll give you an example: if you want to buy an iPhone, you really don’t care whether you buy it on Amazon or Flipkart, or an Apple store. You want to buy an iPhone and sometimes you buy it online, sometimes you buy from an Apple store, and sometimes you buy from a Croma. So yeah, we’re constantly looking at adding more channels at this point. We are quite bullish on our phone channels and we get a lot of orders every day with people calling us and placing orders on board. A lot of people are just chatting and taking advice

ers of glasses, which by the way is a very good number. In India there are 400 million-plus people who need spectacles today and are not wearing them. So I’m not surprised by that number. [It is] safe to say the market is growing about 20-30 per cent and we are growing about 50 per cent-plus year-on-year.

Q: In eyewear, there are a clutch of organised players, such as you, Titan, Bausch & Lomb, etc. But, would you say that a very large part of the market is still unorganised, presenting a penetration opportunity for a player like you?

A: Yes, I would say about 90 per cent of the market is still unorganised. So, Lenskart, Titan and all the other chain players who are doing maybe ₹80-100 crore in revenue, all put together would not be more than 10-12 per cent of the total market. The market is still quite nascent so there are two parts to this: one, which exists where people are buying—[some] 200-250 million